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Web site aims to get more black Bostonians on line

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

Dorchester software developer Kenneth Granderson thinks he's found a way to get more black Bostonians onto the Internet.

Along with other high-tech entrepreneurs, Granderson, president of Inner-City Software Inc., has created a new World Wide Web site that focuses on life in the city's black communities.

The Inner City Access site went on the Internet last Saturday, at http://www.roxbury.com. It's tailored for residents of Roxbury, Dorchester and Mattapan, three Boston communities with large black populations.

The site features listings of local businesses, churches and community organizations, as well as links to information on black history and culture.

Granderson said he and the other entrepreneurs who created Inner City Access "were concerned with the low level of technical literacy in Boston's communities of color and wanted to do something about it."

Relatively few black households have personal computers. The most recent US Commerce Department survey found that 13 percent of black families had personal computers in 1993, compared to 35 percent of white families.

Granderson, however, thinks

Information tailored to minority neighborhoods

this will change if more information of interest to black people is made available over the Internet.

For now, Granderson is counting on help from the Boston Public Library. He said 10 library branches in Dorchester, Roxbury and Mattapan have computers that citizens can use to access the World Wide Web.

In addition, Inner City Access will offer free electronic mail accounts for 60 days to the first 200 people who apply for them. Those who don't know how to use e-mail can get free training at AfriNET, a Brookline-based Internet provider that cosponsors Inner City Access.

Though Granderson sees Inner City Access as a public service, he hopes that it will help his company in the long run. Inner-City Software has been commissioned by the Boston Public Library to produce a CD-ROM on the history of blacks in Boston. An increase in the number of computer-literate black Bostonians can only be good for business.

"In order for us to be successful we have to have a market," said Granderson. "If more people of color are using computers, we'll have more of a target audience."

AT&T to offer PC access to Internet

BLOOMBERG BUSINESS NEWS

NEW YORK – AT&T Corp. will launch a service today that allows individual consumers to link their personal computers to the Internet via PC modems, in an effort to profit from the burgeoning on-line services market.

Currently, AT&T only offers businesses access to the Internet over private phone lines under its AT&T WorldNet Service, which can cost thousands of dollars a month.

With its new service, users can get access to the Internet using a modem, personal computer and phone line. AT&T's entry into this so-called dial-up access market is seen as a threat to smaller Internet access companies such as Net-

com On-Line Communication Services Inc. and UUnet Technologies Inc.

AT&T declined to discuss specifics about pricing of the service. Prices charged by competitors range from $14 to to $35 a month for similar access. AT&T intends to offer Internet access at competitive prices, a spokesman said.

"One of the reasons we are going to be pricing it very aggressively is to bring everyone on the Internet," said Mike Miller, a spokesman at AT&T. "We want to open it up to people who have not used the Internet before."

By offering dial-up access, AT&T hopes to sign up millions of its 80 million residential and 10 million business long-distance phone customers.

Bronner Slosberg vies for GM contract

■ GM
Continued from page 41

World Wide Web, Orsatti said. He noted that such efforts can be more cost effective than producing and buying time for 30-second TV ads.

In many cases, the direct marketing chores for GM car divisions are handled by the same ad agencies that do their traditional print and TV advertising. GM is now considering whether to consolidate much, if not all, of its direct marketing work with a single firm.

According to Adweek, that firm could be Bronner Slosberg.

Bronner Slosberg's present client list includes American Express, AT&T, Fidelity Investments, IBM and L.L. Bean.

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